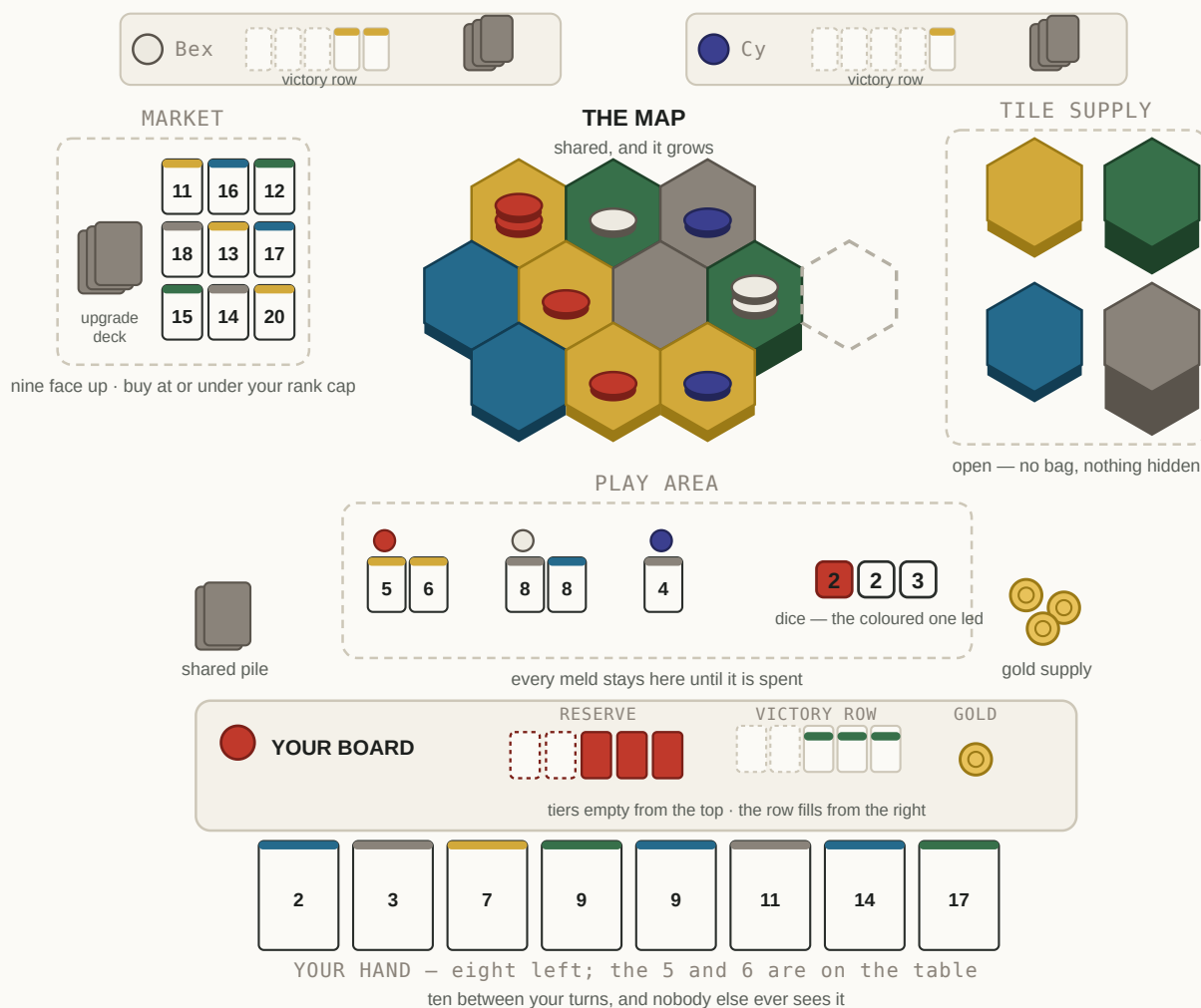


Blink

Climbing the ladder of civilization

2–4 players · age 10+
60–90 minutes · competitive
Toby Siko · Deep Diversions
deep-diversions.com/blink

A game of tricks and territory, in which the cards you play are also the budget you spend. Win the trick and you act first — but every card in that winning meld still has to become a settler, a new tile, an attack, or a coin.



The table from your seat. The map in the middle is shared and grows all game; the market beside it is where cards are bought; every meld played stays in the play area until it is spent.

THE ROUND

Everyone plays a meld at once — **any cards whose ranks form an unbroken run**, duplicates free, suits irrelevant. One rule replaces straights, sets and full houses. Highest total wins the trick and acts first.

Then, in that order, every player spends the very cards they just played: each one settles a unit, explores a tile, attacks a neighbour, or is cashed for gold — always on terrain matching its suit, beside ground you already hold. **The meld is the budget.**

GROWTH IS THE CLOCK, AND THE BILL

Your twenty units sit in five tiers and leave from the top. Each tier you empty raises your meld size, your movement and the rank you may buy — and the food your people cost at every recycle.

COMBAT IS A DUEL

An attack is the card you spent. The defender answers from hand, plus the terrain's defence — forest one, mountain two. Higher rank wins; clear the last defender and the ground changes hands. It is the only moment you act on somebody else's turn, and it makes the cards you hold back worth holding.

HOW IT ENDS

It ends when a player places their last unit, or the market thins to its last layer. Score a point per unit on the map; one per card in your victory row, plus the rank in its centre slot; three for each terrain where you hold the largest connected stretch.

WHY IT PLAYS DIFFERENTLY

Trick-taking asks one question — can I win this? Blink asks it twice, in opposite directions: the meld that takes the trick is the meld you must now spend.